



Website Features & User Guide

Doing Business in Bushbuckridge (DBiB)

A complete overview of what the platform does, followed by a step-by-step manual for visitors, business owners and administrators.

Part 1 Website Features

The Doing Business in Bushbuckridge (DBiB) directory is an online platform that connects local enterprises with the community, customers, partners and institutions. It combines a searchable business directory, a jobs board, community events, business opportunities, news features and a self-service portal for business owners — all managed from a single admin dashboard. The sections below explain each feature in plain language.

In short

Customers find trusted local businesses; business owners get an online presence and leads; and the team manages everything — listings, jobs, payments and content — from one place.

For the Community & Customers

• Business Directory — “Find a Service”

The heart of the platform. Visitors can search for what they need even if they don't know the business name, and filter results by sector (industry) and area (town/village). Each result shows the business at a glance, including its star rating from customer reviews.

• Business Profile Pages

Every listed business gets its own professional profile page. Depending on the package, a profile can include a logo, cover image, photo gallery, description, services, business hours, phone, WhatsApp, website and social links, a video showcase, an FAQ section, certifications, special offers, a location map and customer reviews.

• Reviews & Star Ratings

Customers can rate and review businesses. Reviews are moderated by the team before they appear, keeping feedback genuine and the directory trustworthy.

• Jobs Board — “Local Career Opportunities”

A dedicated board of local job openings from businesses in the region. Job seekers can browse roles and open a full listing with all the details and how to apply.

• Business Opportunities

A noticeboard of active tenders, funding applications and business support programmes available to enterprises in the region.

- **Events**

A calendar of monthly happenings across Bushbuckridge — networking sessions, training, markets, workshops and community gatherings.

- **Spotlight Articles & Editor's Spotlight**

In-depth feature articles on leading local businesses and entrepreneurs, plus a curated “Editor's Spotlight” that highlights a featured business.

- **Get in Touch (Enquiries)**

A simple contact form for general questions about listing, advertising or anything else. Messages arrive in the admin dashboard and trigger an email notification to the team.

For Business Owners

- **List Your Business / Buy Your Spot**

Business owners can join the directory through a guided sign-up wizard. There are three annual packages, each unlocking more profile features:

- **Basic Listing** R199/year — a simple, affordable entry-level listing.
- **Pro Lead Package** R799/year — an interactive profile with images, social links, reviews and an enquiry button.
- **Pro Business Listing** R10 500/year — premium visibility with gallery, video, FAQ, offers, performance emails and media exposure.

Payment is handled securely online through Yoco. An account is created automatically so the owner can manage their listing afterwards.

- **Post a Job (Employer Services)**

Employers can submit a job opening through a detailed form — including job title, type, location, salary, requirements, how to apply and even photos. Submissions are reviewed by the team before they appear on the public Jobs board.

- **Client Portal**

After signing up, business owners get a private portal where they can manage their listing details and photos, view and pay invoices, handle renewals, and upgrade their package or unlock premium features.

For the Administrator / Team

- **Admin Dashboard**

A control centre showing key numbers at a glance — total businesses, premium listings, pending approvals and new enquiries.

- **Manage Businesses**

Approve new listings, mark businesses as verified, change package tiers, and edit or remove listings. Only approved (active) businesses appear on the public site.

- **Manage Jobs**

Job submissions arrive as “Pending”. The team can review and edit them, then “Approve & Publish” to make them live on the Jobs board. Live jobs can also be unpublished at any time.

- **Manage Enquiries**

General enquiries are organised into Active and Archive tabs. Once handled, an enquiry is marked resolved (or approved) and moves to the Archive, keeping the inbox tidy.

- **Content: Events, Opportunities & Articles**

Create and manage community events, business opportunities and spotlight articles that appear on the public site.

- **Reviews, Subscriptions & Revenue**

Moderate customer reviews, track active subscriptions and renewals, and view revenue from listing payments.

- **Users & Settings**

Manage admin/team accounts and configure platform settings such as payment (Yoco) keys and package pricing.

Part 2 Step-by-Step Manual

This section explains how to use each feature. It is grouped by who is using the site: visitors and customers, business owners, and the administration team.

A. For Visitors & Customers

A1. Find a local business

1. **Open “Find a Service”** — from the main menu.
2. **Search** — type what you need (e.g. “plumber”) — you don't need the business name.
3. **Filter** — narrow results by sector and area to find businesses near you.
4. **Open a profile** — click a business card to see full details and its star rating.

A2. Contact a business

1. **Open the profile** — of the business you're interested in.
2. **Choose how to reach them** — use the phone, WhatsApp, website or social links shown.
3. **Send an enquiry** — on premium profiles, use the quote/enquiry button to message them directly.

A3. Leave a review

1. **Scroll to the reviews section** — on a business profile.
2. **Add your rating** — choose a star rating and write your comment.
3. **Submit** — your review is sent to the team and appears once approved.

Why approval?

Reviews are checked before publishing to keep feedback genuine and fair.

A4. Browse jobs

1. **Open “Jobs” / Local Career Opportunities** — from the menu.
2. **Browse the listings** — each card shows the role, company and location.
3. **Open a job** — click through for the full description and the “How to Apply” instructions.

A5. View events, opportunities & articles

1. **Pick a section** — Events, Opportunities or Spotlight Articles from the menu.
2. **Open an item** — click any card to read the full details.

A6. Send a general enquiry

1. **Open “Get in Touch”** — from the menu or footer.
2. **Complete the form** — fill in your name, contact details and message.
3. **Submit** — the team receives your message and will respond by email.

B. For Business Owners

B1. List your business

1. **Open “List Your Business”** — review the three packages and pick one.
2. **Create your account** — enter your name, email and a password (Step 1 of the wizard).
3. **Choose your package** — Basic, Pro Lead or Pro Business (Step 2).
4. **Enter business details** — name, sector, area, phone and description. Higher packages unlock extra fields like WhatsApp, website and social links (Step 3).
5. **Review & pay** — check your details and pay securely via Yoco (Step 4).
6. **You're listed** — your account is created and your listing is submitted for approval.

Note

New listings are reviewed by the team before they go live on the public directory.

B2. Post a job opening

1. **Open “Employer Services / Post a Job”** — from the menu.
2. **Fill in the contact details** — company name, contact person, email and phone.
3. **Describe the role** — job title, type, experience level, location, number of positions, salary, closing date, description, responsibilities, requirements and how to apply.
4. **Add photos (optional)** — upload a main photo and up to five gallery images.
5. **Submit for review** — the team reviews and publishes the job to the Jobs board.

B3. Manage your listing (Client Portal)

1. **Log in** — use the Login link with your account email and password.
2. **Open your portal** — view your dashboard and listing.
3. **Edit details & photos** — update your information, logo and gallery from Settings.
4. **Billing & renewals** — view invoices, pay and renew under Billing.
5. **Upgrade** — move to a higher package to unlock more profile features.

C. For the Administration Team

C1. Log in to the admin dashboard

1. **Go to the Admin login** — via the Admin link in the footer.
2. **Sign in** — with your admin credentials to reach the dashboard.
3. **Review the overview** — see total businesses, premium listings, pending approvals and new enquiries.

C2. Approve a business listing

1. **Open “Businesses”** — in the admin menu.
2. **Find the pending business** — review the submitted details.
3. **Set the status to Active** — this publishes it to the public directory.
4. **(Optional) Verify or change tier** — mark as verified or adjust the package.

Tip

Paid listings activate automatically once payment succeeds; manual approval is for any listings that need a check first.

C3. Approve & publish a job

1. **Open “Jobs Hub”** — and select the “Pending Review” tab.
2. **Open the submission** — review the details; use Edit to refine anything (title, salary, photos, etc.).
3. **Approve & Publish** — from the actions menu — the job appears instantly on the public Jobs board.
4. **Unpublish if needed** — live jobs can be moved back to pending at any time from the same menu.

How it flows

Public submissions arrive as Pending and stay hidden until you approve them. Jobs you create directly in the Jobs Hub go live immediately.

C4. Handle enquiries

1. **Open “Enquiries”** — the Active tab shows enquiries that still need attention.
2. **Read the details** — each enquiry shows the sender, contact details and message.
3. **Resolve or approve** — from the actions menu — the enquiry moves to the Archive tab.
4. **Search any time** — use the search box to find enquiries within either tab.

C5. Manage events, opportunities & articles

1. **Open the relevant section** — Events, Opportunities or Articles in the admin menu.
2. **Add or edit** — create a new item or update an existing one.

3. **Publish** — saved items appear in the matching section on the public site.

C6. Moderate reviews

1. **Open “Reviews”** — see newly submitted customer reviews.
2. **Approve or remove** — approved reviews appear on the business profile and count toward its rating.

C7. Spotlight & Editor's Spotlight

1. **Open “Spotlight”** — choose a business to feature.
2. **Set the Editor's Spotlight** — the chosen business is highlighted on the public site.

C8. Subscriptions & revenue

1. **Open “Subscriptions”** — view active plans and upcoming renewals.
2. **Open “Revenue”** — review income from listing payments.

C9. Users & settings

1. **Open “Users”** — add or manage admin/team accounts.
2. **Open “Settings”** — configure payment (Yoco) keys and package pricing.

Part 3 Subscriptions, Renewals & Emails

Every business listing is an annual subscription. This section explains how billing and renewals work, and lists the automatic emails the platform sends.

Important: payments are not automatic

Yoco — the payment provider — does not support recurring or automatic card billing. Card details are never stored and are never charged on their own. Every renewal is a deliberate payment made by the business owner, prompted by reminder emails and completed through a secure checkout link.

How a subscription works

- **Active for a year** When a business pays, its listing becomes active for 12 months (the expiry date is set to one year from the payment).
- **Reminders before expiry** As the expiry date approaches, the system automatically emails the owner reminders with a one-click renewal link.
- **Manual renewal** The owner pays again through Yoco, which starts a fresh 12-month period and keeps the listing live without interruption.
- **If not renewed** If the subscription is not renewed, the listing is hidden from the directory and search results until payment is made.

Renewal — step by step

1. **Reminders begin** — about 30 days before the listing's expiry date, the system starts sending automatic email reminders to the business owner.
2. **Reminders escalate** — further reminders are sent at 14, 7 and 1 day(s) before expiry, each one more urgent — the final reminder warns that the listing will be hidden.
3. **Owner clicks “Renew”** — each email contains a secure one-click renewal link that opens a Yoco checkout for that business's package and amount.
4. **Owner pays** — payment is completed securely through Yoco (no stored or auto-charged card).
5. **Listing restarts** — on success, the subscription is set active for another 12 months and a payment receipt email is sent automatically.

In short

The platform does the chasing (reminder emails) and makes paying effortless (one-click checkout) — but the business owner always makes the actual payment. Nothing is charged automatically.

Emails the system sends

These messages are sent automatically at the right moments. All are branded for Doing Business in Bushbuckridge.

Email	When it is sent	Who receives it
Welcome email	After a new business successfully signs up and pays for the first time. Includes login and portal links.	Business owner
Payment receipt	After every successful payment — both new sign-ups and renewals.	Business owner
New signup / payment alert	When a business signs up or pays, so the team is aware.	Admin team
Renewal reminder — 30 days	30 days before the listing expires (friendly heads-up).	Business owner
Renewal reminder — 14 days	14 days before expiry (a good time to renew).	Business owner
Renewal reminder — 7 days	7 days before expiry (renew now).	Business owner
Renewal reminder — 1 day	The day before expiry (final reminder — listing will be hidden).	Business owner
Enquiry notification	When someone submits a contact / enquiry form.	Admin team
Enquiry confirmation	Confirms a contact-form message was received.	Person who enquired
Monthly performance email	Monthly listing performance summary (a Pro Business perk).	Business owner

Note for the team

Renewal reminders are sent by an automated scheduled job that checks each day for listings nearing expiry. As long as the schedule and email service stay configured, this runs on its own — no manual action is required.

Doing Business in Bushbuckridge

Designed & built by Ember Automations